

Site review, round 2 — design v2 on dev (2026-09-24)

Five independent reviews of <https://dev.base-xtech.com> after the design-v2 relaunch (home, six services, Complex EN+DE, contact modal, mobile menu, legal, 404, Host Grotesk fonts): [conversion](#) · [brand & design](#) · [buyers, 5 personas](#) · [tech SEO / GEO / performance](#) · [growth & blog](#). Round 1: [summary](#).

Scores

Dimension	Round 1	Round 2	Why it moved
Conversion	4.5	6	\$2200 "for Ukraine" card, old home copy, "Approach" boilerplate and the fake form success are gone
Brand	—	6	v2 looks like a premium EU agency; the facts behind it (who, where, entity, named clients) are missing
Visual design	—	7	faithful to Figma; contrast of the accent green, some crops and empty cells
Performance (mobile Lighthouse, home)	64 (live)	87–97	LCP 7.7 s → ~2.1 s; accessibility 77 → 96–97
URLs lost in the relaunch	—	0 of 31	every live URL answers 200 in the new build

Buyer verdicts (would contact): Katrin DE/Xentral ~~no (15%, was ~10%)~~ · Tom UK/configurator ~~maybe ~55% (was ~40%)~~ · Marta EU/Magento ~~**60%**~~ (same) · Lukas CH/white-label ~~~45% (was 50%)~~ · Dana US DTC, mobile (new) ~~**30%**~~.

Verdict: the relaunch is technically ready and clearly better than live on every measurable axis. What holds buyers back now is no longer design or copy but **missing evidence**: nobody named, no location, no legal entity, no price range, best proof (NAYA, Prime EVA) not on the page where buyers decide, and the German page turning English at the form.

Release blockers (before `live`)

No hard blockers. Two items the tech review flagged, re-classified:

#	Item	Status	Fix	Effort
B1	DACH page (EN+DE) has no FAQPage JSON-LD	by decision (Q-19): its 8 FAQs duplicate Integrations, so schema is off to avoid duplicate rich results	write 4–6 DACH-specific FAQs, then switch schema on (<code>data-faq-q/a + "faq": true</code>)	copy + 10 min
B2	Accent-green buttons (white on <code>#81a13f</code>) 2.95:1, below WCAG AA	recommended before release (Q-12 treated contrast as legacy; these are new v2 colours)	darken the accent for text-bearing fills (≈ <code>#5f7a2a</code>) or dark label text	30 min, designer OK
—	GPTBot / meta-externalagent 403 on prod	not a blocker: checked earlier (Q-9) — Cloudflare returns 403 to <i>spoofed</i> bot user-agents, verified crawlers pass	re-confirm in Cloudflare → AI Crawl Control at deploy	5 min

What all five agree on (ranked by impact on qualified leads)

#	Problem	Evidence	Fix	Needs from you
1	Form defaults every lead to "Shopify Development" + "\$2K–5K" in USD , also on DE; the lead doesn't record its page	layout/v2/form.ejs	no budget default, EUR bands, preselect service by page, add page URL to the lead, company optional	EUR bands
2	Nobody is named or located — "Kyiv" is on no EN page, "About" lands on principles, privacy policy has no entity	home, all services, footer	"Who you'll work with" text strip + one line "Team in Kyiv, working CET hours; contracts & invoicing via ..."	entity, invoicing, team size, names/roles
3	Best proof is off the decision page	NAYA (12.4% vs 6.7% A/B) only on home/blog; Prime EVA links to primeeva.com on 6 pages; no Prime EVA / Fresh Market / Xentral case	NAYA with numbers on Dev/Design/CRO; Prime EVA case study; hide external link until then	permission to name clients / numbers
4	German page turns English at the action: nav, footer, form, USD; "Book a call" without a calendar; FAQ copied from Integrations; no Impressum	/de/pages/complex-solutions/	translate shell strings on /de/, own 4–6 DACH FAQs, CTA "Projekt besprechen", Impressum/Datenschutz	Impressum data; Karl decision (with Marko)
5	No price anchor anywhere — the \$2K form default is the only price a buyer sees	all services	one EUR range sentence per service ("typical projects €X–Y")	ranges you'll publish
6	Testimonials recycled — same Gunia quote with 5 tags; "Stealth Startup US" twice on home	content/pages/*.json	one quote = one tag; add role + country	—
7	Unsourced claim "50–200% conversion uplift" (UWG risk in DE)	CRO page	remove or source	OK to remove
8	Three promises: home H1 has no "Shopify", services say "Shopify ... more than a theme", Complex H1 no "Shopify"; title/lms.txt still "web design agency"	home, complex	one umbrella line with "Shopify" under the home H1 and on Complex	Marko OK
9	Empty-looking sections: "When We Can Help" titles without text; process cards and CTA dead areas; 3 project images cropped	service template	fill help copy; fix object-position; tighten cards	—
10	Service pages dead-end: almost no links between services, main CTA is href="#"	all services	related-services row + FAQ links; CTA fallback href="#contact"	—
11	Hreflang conflicts (EN never self-references, EN and UK both x-default); no Open Graph ; soft 404 (/404/ = 200)	head	fix hreflang set; OG tags from page meta; 404 status	—
12	Brand splits: Complex uses a different button/type system; globe → /uk/ old design	complex, header	align Complex buttons to v2; label UK link "Українська (old site)" or hide until redesigned	—

Fixed since round 1

\$2200 pricing card · old home copy · "Approach" boilerplate on services · fake "thank you" on failed send · phone optional · service list = real pages · form typos · "UTC +2" · footer name · 4.8* footnote · case-study links on Innan / UK gifting / Nova Poshta / NAYA cards · mobile: no sideways scroll, working menu and modal · unlicensed font removed.

Suggested order

1. **Today, no input (≈ 1 day):** form defaults + page in lead + preselect service · testimonial tags · help copy · image crops · related-service links · hreflang / OG / 404 status · /de/ shell translation · CTA labels on Complex.
2. **With your facts ($\approx \frac{1}{2}$ day once received):** who/where strip · EUR bands + price ranges · reply time · remove 50–200% · Impressum.
3. **With the designer:** B2 contrast · Complex buttons · empty-card layout.
4. **Then release** (checklist: docs/RELEASE–2026–09–25.md).

Details, quick-win lists and per-page evidence are in the five linked reports. Growth and blog proposals are in [2026-09-24-v2-open-questions-and-growth.md](#).

Open questions, improvements, scaling and the blog (2026-09-24)

Companion to the [round-2 review summary](#). Sources: the five v2 reviews, mainly [growth & blog](#). Earlier questions: docs/OPEN-QUESTIONS.md (Q-1...Q-25).

1. Open questions — who has to answer

Alex (facts only you have)

#	Question	Unblocks	Default until answered
A1	Legal entity, country, invoicing currency; can we say "Team in Kyiv, working CET hours"?	"Who you'll work with" strip, privacy policy, Impressum, consistent profiles	nothing shown (today)
A2	Team size and 2–3 names + roles buyers will talk to (text only, no photos)	trust strip, case bylines	none
A3	EUR budget bands for the form, and a price range per service you are OK to publish	form, price anchor on every service page	no budget pre-selected, no range
A4	Reply time you can keep (e.g. "within 1 business day")	form success + note under Send	"shortly"
A5	Remove "50–200% conversion uplift" on CRO, or give the source	UWG risk in DE, trust	keep until you say remove
A6	Which delivered project was the Xentral work; can it and Prime EVA / Fresh Market / Gunia / VT Advantec be named with numbers?	case studies, Xentral landing page, DACH proof	anonymous
A7	Paid entry offers — do we sell a fixed-price Integration Audit and Migration Scoping ? Price?	DACH/Integrations/Migration CTAs, Katrin/Marta personas	not offered
A8	Clutch shows \$25–49/h — keep or change? Partner Directory says London, Clutch Kyiv/Lviv/Kraków: which story?	consistent profiles (AI assistants merge them)	unchanged
A9	Ghost admin access for Marko (link tagging, nav, CTAs, blog title "AI tooling ... Asia-Pacific")	blog fixes	—
A10	Delete the <code>design-v2</code> GitHub branch (merged; auto-guard blocked me)	tidy repo	keep
A11	Release date and "go" for <code>staging</code> → <code>live</code> after your dev check	prod	not pushed

Marko (copy / content)

#	Question	Default
M1	Karl block: his photo, a monogram tile, or no person at all (your talk with Marko)	placeholder, page on dev only
M2	4–6 DACH-specific FAQs (then FAQ schema goes on; Q-19)	Integrations FAQ, no schema
M3	One umbrella line with "Shopify" under the home H1 and on Complex (H1 stays as designed)	none
M4	"When We Can Help" descriptions on service pages (titles only today)	empty cells
M5	Alexander's own first-person quote (DE + EN)	current generic quote
M6	Home principles "Pragmatic innovation" / "Long-term thinking" have no text — fill or drop	shown empty

#	Question	Default
M7	One tag per testimonial (Gunia quote is used with 5 tags) — confirm the correct context for each	first tag

Designer (Ira)

#	Question	Default
D1	Accent green fails contrast with white text (2.95:1) — darker accent for buttons/tiles or dark label?	as designed
D2	Complex uses its own pill buttons / centred layout — align with v2 service system?	as in Figma
D3	Empty areas in process cards / CTA; cropped project images (UK gifting, Mo, Innan)	fixing crops with object-position
D4	/uk/ pages are still the old design — redesign, or label the link "Українська (стара версія)"?	linked as is

2. Improvements I can do without anyone (≈ 1 day)

Form: no pre-selected budget, service pre-selected from the page, page URL + first landing page + referrer + UTM in every lead, company optional, "How did you find us?" select · testimonial tags · related-services row + FAQ cross-links · Prime EVA card without the off-site link until the case exists · hreflang self-reference / x-default · Open Graph tags · real 404 status · /de/ header/footer/form in German · Complex CTA "Discuss your project / Projekt besprechen" · llms-full.txt cleanup · GA4 events (form_open , email_click , blog_to_service , profile_click) + key events + "AI assistants" channel group · Bing Webmaster + IndexNow.

3. Scaling for clients — what to build next

Principle from the growth review: **proof first, page second**. Every new page must stand on a delivered project; a page for a system you never delivered is thin content and, for German buyers, a UWG risk.

Priority	What	Why	Effort
1	Lead-source tracking (form fields + ClickUp fields Source / Service / Value / Won)	without it no channel, page or blog post can be judged	S
2	Case studies for Prime EVA, Fresh Market, the Xentral project, Gunia, VT Advantec	the missing evidence behind every persona's "maybe"; also what AI assistants cite	M each
3	Per-system landing pages where you have delivered: Shopify + Xentral (EN + DE), Shopify POS + inventory	"shopify xentral" SERP is Xentral docs + their partners — reachable	M
4	Per-use-case pages : custom product configurator (NAYA, Prime EVA); later B2B/wholesale; white-label for agencies	configurator SERP is app listicles, few real custom builds	M
5	Shopware → Shopify guide (DE + EN)	main DACH migration route; covered nowhere on site or blog	M
6	Paid entry offers : Integration Audit, Migration Scoping (credited against the build)	converts cautious €5–15k buyers better than an e-book	S (copy) + your decision
7	DE expansion : Impressum/Datenschutz, DE form, Xentral DE page, then DE Migration + Integrations (native, Karl reviews)	DACH is where Karl adds leverage	M–L
8	Portfolio index /work/ with filters (service, system, country) — in the Sanity build	one place to send buyers and assistants	L

Don't: industry pages with one project each; "Shopify + SAP/Salesforce" pages (no project yet); machine-translating all six pages; trying to rank for "Shopify Agentur".

Channels that feed the site, ranked by leads per hour: 1 Karl (DE one-pager, Loom, monthly list of target merchants) · 2 Shopify Partner Directory (8 reviews, German, fix location) · 3 Clutch (3 fresh reviews, Shopify focus, rate) · 4 Xentral partner programme (after the Xentral case) · 5 white-label agency partners · 6 LinkedIn from people (Alex, Marko; 1 post/week each) · 7 Upwork (cash flow, ≥ \$3k) · 8 "best agency" listicles (low direct, high for AI citations). Google Ads only after tracking and per-system pages exist.

4. The blog — more weight or not?

Yes, more weight — but not more volume, and a different mix.

- You already publish a lot (21 posts since May, 10 in July). The problem is what and how it connects: 7 of 21 are generic / seasonal / AI-opinion and support no service; the 4 migration guides and 5 case studies are barely linked from service pages; 9 posts link to no service page; **every blog CTA is a `mailto:`**, so blog leads bypass ClickUp and GA4 — today you cannot see what the blog produces.
- **New mix:** ~50% case studies · ~35% system-specific integration/migration guides (DE where DACH) · ~15% cost/decision pieces from your own project numbers · stop generic/news/opinion (refresh only).
- **Cadence:** 4 pieces/month (12 in Oct–Dec) + 2 refreshes/month. First four: Prime EVA case · Fresh Market case (EN + DE) · "Shopify + Xentral: what the standard connector doesn't cover" (DE first) · Shopware → Shopify guide.
- **Who:** Marko owns calendar and editing; the developer who built it gives a 45-min interview + review (~2 h); Alex gets client approvals; Karl co-signs DE pieces.
- **Definition of done per post:** link to its service page in the first third · CTA card that opens the form (no `mailto:`) · the service page links back the same week · named author + technical reviewer · added to `llms.txt`.
- **Fix now in Ghost:** outbound `?ref=` tagging off, one 404 link, nav still points to 4 absorbed service pages, blog home title/H1 "AI tooling ... Asia-Pacific", 50 tag pages for 21 posts.
- **Platform:** stay on Ghost until the Sanity site ships; then decide with 6 months of `blog_to_service` → `generate_lead` data.

5. Roadmap

When	Items
Before release (this week)	section 2 fixes · contrast decision (D1) · your facts A1–A5 · release
Next 2 weeks	lead-source tracking live, October baseline · service ↔ blog links · Ghost hygiene · blog CTA cards · Partner Directory + Clutch review requests · DACH own FAQ · start Prime EVA case
90 days (Oct–Dec)	12 blog pieces per plan · Xentral page EN + DE · DE legal + DE form · Xentral partner application · entry offers live · monthly review: leads / qualified / won by source and landing page + 10-prompt AI visibility check
6 months (Jan–Mar 2027, with Sanity)	<code>/work/</code> portfolio · per-system pages for each newly delivered system · configurator + B2B pages · per-source migration pages · partners page · DE Migration + Integrations · Google Ads test on DE/EN long tail

Measure one thing monthly: qualified leads (≥ €5k) and won value by source and by landing page. That answers "does the blog work" and "which page to build next".